

Conversations

Call, IM, SMS, e-mail, contacts—that's conversation. Let's start with contacts. Open the keyboard and type a contact's name, and it automatically opens the list and starts filtering. Tap a contact, and if things are set up properly, you'll have the option to call, SMS, Skype and IM (based on your IM accounts and settings). See Figure 21. Since my GTalk account is already set up, I have the options for GTalk call and chat, right there. Thanks to the VGA camera at the front, video conferencing over GTalk is a pleasure. Take a look at Figure 22.

Both SMSs and IMs figure in threaded lists for each contact I've had a chat with. For e-mails, you have to configure a separate mail client application—but it uses the same address book as far as integration is concerned. Talking about integration, you better have your contact list set up properly, with the e-mail, IM, phone number, etc. fields.

In my case, my phone numbers came from the SIM card, while the IM contacts came from the GTalk account. So what I had were multiple entries for the same contact. A good feature that the contacts program provides is to manually merge a contact with another—and this is how I had managed to put things in place. An easy way would have been if only my Gmail contacts' list had all the details filled in.

When you're busy with conversing with a contact, or just working on something else, a nice translucent yellow pop-up appears on the top of the screen to show a part of the incoming SMS/IM/e-mail (Figure 23). It stays for a few seconds—you can immediately click to view it—and

disappears in the background, leaving the dashboard icon glowing to notify you of a new message.

For normal calls, I found volume to be a bit low. Sometimes I really had to push the phone against my ear. A good thing is that the device comes with a proximity sensor. So the moment the phone is brought near the ear, the display shuts off. This is a very important feature; otherwise, imagine pressing the phone close to your ear and somehow hitting the call end button in the way.

Package manager

The App manager (Figures 25, 26 and 27) works just like Synaptic. After all, it's *apt-get* at the backend. By default, it comes with four repositories (package catalogues) enabled—Nokia Applications, Nokia System Software Updates, Ovi and maemo.org. The last one is where community-supported apps are hosted, and this is the main resource for most of the apps you'll install to the device. The repositories sync with the online repos at regular intervals, and if there are updates to any application, you get a notification in your system tray, just like you get in your desktop computer.

To begin with, I had some issues with the app manager. The official Nokia repos just won't sync, and because of this I was also unable to install a lot of apps—because, either the app manager wasn't able to find the package, or some won't install as the packages they depended on were hosted in the Nokia repos. Perhaps, this is also the reason I wasn't notified of the Maemo update in the beginning that made me flash the device



Figure 21: Addressbook of a contact



Figure 23: IM chat window



Figure 22: Video conferencing on GTalk

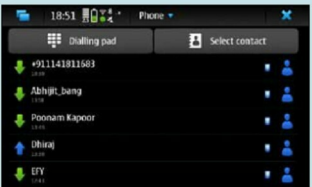


Figure 24: Recently dialled numbers